

Balanced College List

FILL IN TOGETHER

Sorts every school you are considering into Likely, Target and Reach so you can see at a glance whether the list is balanced — or whether it is eight reaches and a prayer.

When: Spring of junior year, revisited each time you visit a campus

Likely — you would very probably be admitted

Aim for two or three. At least one you would genuinely be happy to attend.

College	Why it fits	Est. net price	Deadline

Target — your numbers sit in the middle of their admitted range

Aim for three or four. This is where most acceptances come from.

College	Why it fits	Est. net price	Deadline

Reach — admission would be a genuine stretch

Two or three is plenty. Every school with an admit rate under 20% is a reach for everyone.

College	Why it fits	Est. net price	Deadline

The honest check

- ☐ At least one Likely school we can afford without loans
- ☐ Every school on this list is one my student would actually attend
- ☐ We have run the net price calculator for every single one
- ☐ The list has more Targets than Reaches

WORTH KNOWING

- ◆ A school is only a Likely if it is likely on money as well as admission.
- ◆ Reaches are fine. A list made only of reaches is not a list, it is a lottery ticket.
- ◆ Rebuild this sheet after every campus visit — opinions change once you stand there.